Code of Conduct for the SMLP summer schools

The organizing team of the SMLP summer school is committed to respecting and promoting diversity, equality, inclusion, and freedom of expression. We strive to create a productive, safe, and discrimination- and harassment-free environment for all participants. By participating in the summer school in any capacity, you agree to respect and uphold this Code of Conduct. All forms of disrespectful behavior—and specifically, all forms of harassment—are unacceptable.

Unacceptable Behaviors
Forms of disrespectful behavior include (physically or virtually) the following:

- Harassment or intimidation based on (attributed) personal characteristics such as age; biological, psychological, or social gender; geographic, cultural, or ethnolinguistic characteristics; neurodivergent characteristics; political views; physical appearance; mental or physical disability; religion or secularism; sexual orientation; socioeconomic status; or the intersection of these factors.
- Derogatory verbal or written statements that refer to the categories listed above and create a hostile environment (e.g., sexist or racist jokes).
- Sexual harassment or intimidation, including unwanted sexual attention and unwanted physical contact.
- Patterns of inappropriate or intrusive social contact, such as demanding or accepting inappropriate intimacy or continuing personal conversations after being asked to stop.
- Unwanted photography, audio, or video recordings, stalking, or harassment.
- Threatening or inciting violence against a person, including encouraging the person to engage in self-harming behavior.
- Publicly disclosing aspects of a person's identity or (attributed) group affiliation against their will (e.g., outing their sexual orientation); or using names or terms for a person that they reject (e.g., deadnaming, misgendering).
- Persistent disruption of speakers or events (verbal or physical).
- Unwanted comments about a person's lifestyle habits and practices, including those related to diet, health, parenting, and employment.
- Retaliation against a person who has reported harassment or other unacceptable behavior, or who has participated in an investigation of such an allegation.
- Advocating for or encouraging any of the behaviors listed above.

To determine whether disrespectful behavior is present in a specific situation, it may be helpful to draw on the concept of structural discrimination, as disrespectful actions often constitute forms of structural discrimination. Structural discrimination manifests itself at the individual, cultural, and institutional levels and relates, among other things, to the personal characteristics mentioned at the outset.

This Code of Conduct is intended to ensure the conditions necessary for open and respectful scientific research and communication. Critical examination, discussion, and strong

disagreements regarding beliefs and viewpoints that are relevant to the topic under discussion and are presented respectfully do not, in and of themselves, constitute harassment.

We expect all individuals participating in any edition of SMLP to adhere to this Code of Conduct in all matters related to the conference.

Consequences
All SMLP participants are expected to look out for one another and intervene if they observe the behaviors described above. If a person is asked to cease harassing behavior, they are expected to comply with this request immediately. The summer school organizing team reserves the right to take various measures to ensure compliance with the Code of Conduct. These include:

- Speaking with the individuals involved
- Expulsion from the summer school
- Exclusion from future summer schools
- Filing a police report

Reporting Incidents and Seeking Help
If you or someone you know experiences or suspects disrespectful or abusive behavior at the conference, please report it to a member of the conference organizing committee. You can report an incident by contacting any of the following people:

Nicole Cruz
Reinhold Kliegl
Shravan Vasishth

You can approach them directly at the summer school. All reports will be forwarded to the summer school organizers, who will then decide on appropriate measures.

Confidentiality and Safety
We respect requests for confidential handling of a report where this serves to protect a victim of abuse. If there are safety concerns, we reserve the right to publicly name a person against whom harassment allegations have been made or to warn third parties in a private conversation in their presence. We do not disclose the names of harassment victims without their express consent.

Appeals
If you believe you have been wrongly accused of violating this Code of Conduct, please report this to Shravan Vasishth with a brief description of your perspective. The organizers will decide on any appeals against these measures.

Conflicts of Interest

The organizers and all other individuals responsible for implementing or monitoring these measures shall recuse themselves if they have a conflict of interest. This includes situations where they are a specific target of harassment or an alleged harasser, or if they have a close personal or professional relationship with an affected person or an accused person.

Feedback

We look forward to working together to foster a safe, pleasant, and respectful atmosphere for professional and critical scientific exchange. Please feel free to send us feedback on this Code of Conduct or on other aspects of how diversity and discrimination are addressed at the conference by contacting Shravan Vasishth.

Sources & Credits

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Edits and English version by Shravan Vasishth

Adapted From and Inspired By

- Complex Human Data Summer School 2018, University of Melbourne, Australia https://djnavarro.net/chdss2018/coc.html
- Human Rights Watch Switzerland humanrights.ch
- Rladies https://www.rladies.org/coc/
- Society for Mathematical Psychology https://mathpsych.org/page/code-of-conduct
- Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science (SIPS) https://improvingpsych.org/sipsinaction/code/

Additional Resources

For more detailed information on the development and implementation of a code of conduct, see:
https://adainitiative.org/continue-our-work/conference-policies/
https://files.frameshiftconsulting.com/books/cocguide.pdf